

BREAKING THE SHACKLES

TIPS ON HOW TO HAVE A HEALTHY RELATIONSHIP WITH YOUR DEVICE

- **Turn off all screens,** including the television, one hour before going to bed
- **Follow the 20-20-20 rule:** take a break every 20 minutes, look at an object 20 feet away for 20 seconds–this gives your eyes a much-needed break from the light of your screen
- **Instal protective software** on sites restricted for young children
- **Create screen-free zones at home** where no one in the family is allowed to use gadgets
- **Schedule a 'digital fast'** on certain days every month when gadget use is prohibited
- **Be a role model for your children** by following the same rules for healthy media use as them
- **Openly discuss device overuse issues** and freely voice concerns about any member showing signs of digital addiction

–Dr Hirak Patel
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